

R-ClaimLab: From R Code to Evidence

A Reproducible R Framework for Interactive Data Learning

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Prepared for the R Consortium ISC 2026-2 submission. Yeonji Jung is designated as proposed Co-Lead for Community Validation and Adoption; final public-attribution confirmation, January-June 2027 availability, and milestone acceptance remain pending. Pre-submission review and pilot evidence will be added only with permission; no unconfirmed endorsement is claimed.

Executive Summary

R-ClaimLab will provide a small, reusable R package and Quarto authoring framework for reproducible data-science lessons. R educators can readily publish code, text, and two-dimensional graphics, but an interactive multivariate lesson still requires authors to coordinate analysis data, browser rendering, learner prompts, accessible alternatives, environment locking, and publishing. Existing examples are often tied to one course or an opaque hosted service and are difficult for another instructor to adapt.

The project will turn a working prototype into community-ready R infrastructure. Authors will use `lesson_spec()`, `as_rclaimlab_evidence()`, `compile_lesson()`, and `check_lesson()` to convert an existing R analysis into a documented Quarto lesson, portable Evidence Intermediate Representation, semantic table, optional 2D or 3D view, and release checks. Learners can predict a result, edit and execute R locally through a pinned WebR runtime, inspect linked evidence, explain it, transfer the reasoning, and save a reproducibility receipt. The 3D/browser layer demonstrates the evidence contract; the Evidence Compiler is the package contribution. The optional AI Visual Brief is outside the funded scope.

Grant work will stabilize the package API and Evidence IR schema, harden adapters for data frames, PCA, regression, classification, and clustering, validate the ten-lesson baseline with a community-authored adaptation, expand reproducibility and browser-accessibility checks, conduct a small educator and learner feasibility pilot, and publish contributor training and maintenance documentation. Before submission, the project will seek two short R/Quarto reviews and one structured usability pilot, then connect each finding to a proposal revision or public issue. The prototype reduces delivery risk by demonstrating the analysis-to-receipt workflow now. We request **\$10,000 for six months, January through June 2027**. Existing prototype and submission-period validation are in-kind evidence and are not charged retroactively.

Signatories

Project team

- **Jewoong Moon, Project Lead and primary contractor.** Responsible for learning-experience design, R and Quarto integration, reproducibility workflow, documentation, community coordina-

tion, and project reporting. Track record and current implementation are available in the [public R-ClaimLab repository](#).

- **Yeonji Jung, proposed Co-Lead for Community Validation and Adoption, Assistant Professor at Texas A&M University; final confirmation pending.** She is designated to own Milestone 4: recruiting and coordinating the educator/learner feasibility pilot, organizing contributor onboarding, translating findings into tracked issues, and co-reviewing the release and final community report. Final public attribution is contingent on her written consent, confirmation of availability from January through June 2027, and acceptance of this milestone. Jewoong Moon remains the proposed primary contractor; any co-lead compensation or subcontracting will be documented only after contract and institutional requirements are confirmed. The Project Lead remains able to deliver the technical scope if the role is not finalized.

Contributors

Two R/Quarto reviewers and contributors to lesson examples, accessibility review, code, or proposal feedback will be named here only after confirming how they wish to be credited. Their comments will be recorded as short structured reviews and linked to resulting revisions or issues.

Consulted

Before submission, the project will invite at least two R or Quarto educators or maintainers to review the need, scope, API, and reuse plan and will run at least one short structured usability session. Attributable feedback or a de-identified summary will be linked when permission and applicable review requirements allow. No unconfirmed endorsement or completed human validation is claimed in this draft.

The Problem

R instructors who want learners to reason about multivariate results must assemble several systems: R data preparation, interactive rendering, explanatory prompts, accessible alternatives, reproducible environments, and publishing. These pieces are usually built ad hoc. The result is duplicated effort, fragile course examples, and activities that other instructors cannot readily inspect or reuse.

The problem affects instructors, package authors, workshop organizers, contributors, and learners. Instructors need a maintainable route from an R analysis to an interactive lesson. Learners need guided evidence-based reasoning instead of a visualization that is merely viewed, plus a non-pointer path when a 3D canvas is inaccessible. Maintainers need examples that can be checked automatically when data, packages, browsers, or publishing tools change.

R already offers strong analysis, visualization, Shiny, WebGL, WebAssembly, and publishing capabilities. R-ClaimLab does not replace these projects. Its package-level contribution is a focused educational layer connecting R-generated data, an explicit learning workflow, accessible evidence inspection, reproducibility checks, and contribution practices. The browser-first design makes headsets optional and avoids proprietary application servers. The 3D view is a progressive enhancement; the R data contract and semantic table remain useful without it.

Solving this problem will let the R community share evidence-centered laboratories as open educational resources. An instructor will be able to adapt an existing `data.frame`, `prcomp`, `lm`, `glm`, or `kmeans` result into a lesson, connect prompts and assessment criteria to stable evidence identifiers, verify the build, and publish through an ordinary Quarto workflow. Contributors can improve adapters, adapt examples to new domains, translate lessons, and reuse the checks in other educational projects.

The Proposal

Overview

R-ClaimLab will become a small R package and Quarto lesson framework for turning analysis results into inspectable learning evidence. R remains the source of data and analysis. The funded core is an Evidence Compiler: `lesson_spec()` defines the learning contract, `as_rclaimlab_evidence()` adapts an existing analysis object, `compile_lesson()` produces linked artifacts, and `check_lesson()` validates release criteria. Stable evidence identifiers connect source values, table rows, visual marks, explanation criteria, transfer responses, and reproducibility receipts. A pinned WebR runtime and browser view demonstrate the learner-facing contract; the semantic table, exported R/Quarto source, and precompiled artifacts preserve value when WebR or 3D is unavailable. The optional AI Visual Brief is documented but is not a grant deliverable.

The grant will fund the future work needed to move from prototype to community infrastructure: API stabilization, reusable authoring primitives, a community-authored lesson adaptation, stronger checks, external validation, contributor onboarding, and a documented release process.

Minimum viable product

1. A tested R package with stable S3 classes for lessons, evidence, builds, and receipts; adapters for `data.frame`, `prcomp`, `lm`, `glm`, and `kmeans`; edge-case validation; and machine-readable reports.
2. A Quarto template implementing Orient, Predict, Run R, Explore, Explain, Repair, Transfer, and Reproduce across semantic table, 2D, and optional 3D representations.
3. Ten openly licensed reference lessons spanning foundational statistics, data science, learning analytics, and educational data mining, with a community-authored adaptation planned during the grant.
4. Strict release checks for substantive data licenses, deterministic seeds, environment locks, portable paths, required learning-loop elements, accessible alternatives, and generated-artifact hashes, plus a real-browser smoke check for keyboard behavior and responsive overflow.
5. An authoring guide, accessibility guide, contributor pathway, pilot protocol, and issue templates.
6. Continuous integration for package tests, lesson checks, and Quarto rendering.

Architecture and dependencies

R prepares and validates author-supplied data and analysis objects. Each adapter converts an established result into the `rclaimlab-evidence-2` schema without reimplementing the statistical method. The package writes portable JSON, Quarto, HTML, and receipt artifacts. WebR can execute learner-edited R and return evidence while table, 2D, and optional 3D renderers consume the same identifiers. A checker produces human-readable and machine-readable reports, and continuous integration repeats the checks and renders examples.

Core dependencies are R, Quarto, WebR, standard browser APIs, `testthat`, and openly licensed datasets. The project will pin tested versions and document every external asset. WebR 0.6.0 is currently loaded from its public runtime URL for first-run browser execution; offline vendor/self-host support is not claimed as complete. No account, proprietary service, headset, or application server is required for learners.

Assumptions, risks, and recovery

- **3D is useful only for selected multivariate tasks.** The pilot will test task fit. The framework will retain table-first and two-dimensional alternatives when 3D adds no instructional value.
- **A pinned WebR runtime remains maintainable.** The release will expose loading and error states and evaluate self-hosted runtime assets. Browser execution is an enhancement; author-side rendering and accessible artifacts remain available.
- **Educators can author concise evidence prompts.** Contributor training will include editable prompt patterns and a review rubric.
- **Scope could expand into a general XR platform.** The grant excludes headset-native applications, multiplayer systems, accounts, cloud analytics, offline WebR vendoring, model training, and a general-purpose 3D grammar. AI-generated briefs remain optional, reviewable, and unfunded.
- **Early adoption may be limited.** Success will use documented reuse intent, pilot completion, outside contribution, and maintainable artifacts, not inflated usage counts.

Project Plan

Start-up and technical delivery

The public repository, licenses, contribution guide, code of conduct, prototype lessons, and continuous-integration workflow already exist. During the first month, the team will confirm roles, publish reporting checkpoints, convert remaining prototype decisions into a release schema, and open milestone issues for community review.

Budgeted deliverable package	Target	Grant-period outcome	Budget
1. Package and API hardening	Jan. 31, 2027	Stable API, schema, edge-case tests, and release criteria	\$2,800
2. Reusable lesson system	Mar. 15, 2027	Quarto authoring primitives and one community-authored lesson adaptation	\$2,400
3. Reproducibility and browser accessibility	Apr. 15, 2027	Strict JSON/Markdown checks, CI evidence, and browser keyboard/overflow validation	\$2,200
4. External validation, release, and maintenance	Jun. 30, 2027	Educator/novice feasibility pilot, contributor training, tagged release, and report	\$2,600
Total			\$10,000

The rows identify project work-package totals, outcomes, and partial-funding priorities; they do not request four separate payments or presume individual payment allocations, and contract terms govern disbursement. Funds support direct labor during the grant period. No indirect costs, travel, lodging,

food, publication fees, or personal hardware are requested. Existing prototype code, UI refinement, narration, screenshots, and the ten current lessons are in-kind feasibility evidence and are not charged retroactively.

The Project Lead owns deliverable packages 1-3. Yeonji Jung, the proposed Co-Lead for Community Validation and Adoption, will own package 4 after written consent, January-June 2027 availability, and milestone acceptance are confirmed. Before submission, two R/Quarto reviewers and at least one short usability participant will be recruited for in-kind validation; their findings will be dispositioned as proposal revisions, release issues, or documented out-of-scope items.

Community availability and dissemination

Code will remain MIT licensed. Original educational content and templates will use CC BY 4.0, and datasets will retain explicit source licenses. Work will be developed in public issues with contribution templates and quarterly progress notes. The team will solicit feedback from R educators, maintainers, and an R user group or comparable community, prepare an R Consortium blog update, and publish an end-of-project report that connects pilot findings to resolved issues and remaining work.

Success

Definition of done

- Package functions and lesson checks pass in continuous integration.
- Ten complete reference lessons render from documented, locked environments; the grant validates reuse and adds a community-authored adaptation.
- Every example supports keyboard operation and a semantic data alternative.
- Authoring, accessibility, contribution, validation, and maintenance documentation is public.
- A tagged release and final project report are archived and linked from the repository.

Measuring success

- Two R educators or maintainers complete a documented API/scope review, with concrete reuse or review outcomes linked publicly or summarized with permission.
- Five novice learners and two instructors are invited to the structured feasibility protocol; the report records invitations, completed sessions, task times, facilitator interventions, and drop-offs rather than inferring effectiveness from a small sample.
- At least four of five novice learners complete the Predict, Run R, Explore, and Explain loop without facilitator intervention, reported as raw counts with limitations; if recruitment is smaller, the target is reported as not estimable rather than silently changed.
- All critical accessibility defects found in the browser smoke test or external review are fixed or explicitly documented before release.
- At least one contributor outside the core team completes an issue, lesson adaptation, or documentation improvement.

Future work

After the grant, contributors can add domain-specific lesson packs, localization, optional WebXR adapters, and integrations with established R visualization packages. These extensions remain outside the funded MVP so the six-month project can deliver a stable reusable foundation.